CITY OF LONDON SCHOOL

ENGLISH DEPARTMENT

GROUP 3 ENTRANCE EXAMINATION

JANUARY 2008

Time allowed: 1 Hour.

This examination consists of THREE sections, A, B and C.

Section A: 34 Marks.
Section B: 32 Marks.
Section C: 34 Marks.

Answer the questions in the spaces provided.

Section A

Read the poem below and then answer the questions which follow. Use full sentences in your answers. (Numbers in round brackets are line numbers.)

THE LESSON

`Your father's gone,' my bald headmaster said.
His shiny dome and brown tobacco jar
Splintered at once in tears. It wasn't grief.
I cried for knowledge which was bitterer
Than any grief. For there and then I knew (5)
That grief has uses – that a father dead
Could bind the bully's fist a week or two;
And then I cried for shame, then for relief.

I was a month past ten when I learnt this:
I still remember how the noise was stilled (10)
In school-assembly when my grief came in.
Some goldfish in a bowl quietly sculled
Around their shining prison on its shelf.
They were indifferent. All the other eyes
Were turned towards me. Somewhere in myself (15)
Pride, like a goldfish, flashed a sudden fin.

1. What does the HM mean when he says 'Your father's gone' (line 1)? **[3 Marks]**

2. What was the boy's immediate reaction to this news? **[3 Marks]**

3. What was the boy's first feeling when he heard the news? **[4 Marks]**

4. What seems to have been happening to the boy at school before he heard this news? **[3 Marks]**

5. What, in order, were the reasons for which the boy cried? **[3 Marks]**

6. Why did the boy feel pride? **[4 Marks]**

7. The last line of the poem contains one of the following: hyperbole, simile, cliché, ellipsis, non-sequitur. Which is it? **[2 Marks]**

8. What is the evidence that the person writing this poem is looking back on something that happened some time ago? **[3 Marks]**

9. Imagine you are the boy in the poem. Write a letter to your best friend, explaining how you heard the news and the way you felt in the assembly when it was announced by the HM. You may include things that are not mentioned in the poem but these must be relevant/appropriate. (Set out your letter properly.) **[9 Marks]**

[Total Marks for Section A: 34 Marks]

NOW GO ON TO SECTION B

Section B

1. ***In this passage there are twelve spelling mistakes. In the spaces below, write out next to the numbers the correct spellings of the words which you think have been spelt incorrectly.***

[1 Mark for each correction = Total 12 Marks]

It was the last day of term. The school had broken up, and William was making his slow and thoughtfull way homeward. A causal observer would have thought that William alone among the leaping, hurrying crowd was a true student, that William alone regreted the four weaks of enforced idleness that lay before him. He walked draggingly and as if reluctently, his brow heavily furrowed, his eyes fixed on the ground. But it was not the thought of the four weeks of holiday that was worrying William. It was a suspition, amounting almost to a certainty, that he wasn't going to have the for weeks of holiday.

The whole trouble had begun with William's headmaster – a man who was in William's eyes a blend of Nero and Judge Jeffreys and the Spanish Inquistioners, but who was in reality a harmless inoffensive man, anxious to do his duty to the youth intrusted to his care. William's father had happened to meet him in the train going up to town, and had asked him how William was getting on. The headmaster had replied truthfully and sadly that William didn't seem to be getting on at all. He hadn't, he said, the true scholar's zest for knoledge, his writing was atroshous and he didn't seem able to spell the simplest word or do the simplest sum. Then, brightning, he suggested that William should have coaching during the holidays.

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

4. _____ 5. _____ 6. _____

7. _____ 8. _____ 9. _____

10. _____ 11. _____ 12. _____

NOW GO ON TO QUESTION 2 OF SECTION B

2. **Later in the same story, William meets an aunt who has not seen him for years and is coming to visit his family although she does not know the way to his house. William says he will help her and then pretends that he has got them lost in a wood.**

In this passage there are <u>Ten</u> numbered places where punctuation marks have been deliberately omitted. In the spaces below, write next to the numbers the code letter from the list below the passage which you think corresponds to the required punctuation mark.

[Total Marks for Question 2: 20 Marks.]

(1)Are we – nearly there, dear boy(2)' she said(3)

They had almost reached the end of the wood, and another few minutes would have brought them out into the main road, where a bus would take them to within a few yards of William(4)s home. William still had no intention of going home, and he felt a fierce resentment against his companion(5) Her chatter had prevented him giving his whole mind to the problem that confronted him. He felt sure that there was a solution if only he could think of it.

He sat down abruptly on a fallen tree and said casually(6)

`I'm afraid we(7)re lost(8) We must have took the wrong turning. This wood goes on for miles an(9) miles. People(10)ve sometimes been lost for days.'

A. full-stop
B. comma
C. question mark
D. exclamation mark
E. apostrophe needed
F. colon
G. semi-colon
H. quotation marks

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

4. _____ 5. _____ 6. _____

7. _____ 8. _____ 9. _____

10. _____

NOW GO ON TO SECTION C.

Section C

Read the story below, and then answer the questions which follow. Use full sentences in your answers. (Numbers in round brackets are line numbers.)

THE KNOCK AT THE MANOR GATE

It was summer, a hot day. With my sister I was passing the gate of a great house on my way home. I cannot tell now whether she knocked on the gate out of mischief or out of the absence of mind, or merely threatened it with her hand and did not knock at all. A hundred paces farther along the road, which here turned to the left, began the village. We did not know it very well, but no sooner had we passed the first house when people appeared and made friendly or warning signs to us; they were themselves apparently terrified, bowed down with terror.

They pointed towards the manor house that we had passed and reminded us of the knock on the gate. The proprietor of the manor would charge us with it, the interrogation would begin immediately. I remained quite calm and also tried to calm my sister's fears. Probably she had not struck the door at all, and if she had it could never be proved. I tried to make this clear to the people around us; they listened to me but refrained from passing any opinion. Later they told me that not only my sister, but I too, as her brother, would be charged. I nodded and smiled. We all gazed back at the manor, as one watches a distant smoke-cloud and waits for the flames to appear. And right enough we presently saw horsemen riding in through the wide-open gate. Dust rose, concealing everything, only the tops of the tall spears glittered. And hardly had the troop vanished into the manor courtyard before they seemed to have turned their horses again, for they were already on their way to us. I urged my sister to leave me, I myself would set everything right. I told her that she should at least change, so as to appear in better clothes before these gentlemen.

At last she obeyed and set out on the long road to our home. Already the horsemen were beside us, and even before dismounting they enquired after my sister. She wasn't here at the moment, was the apprehensive reply, but she would come later. The answer was received with indifference; the important thing seemed their having found me. The chief members of the party appeared to be a young lively fellow, who was a judge, and his silent assistant, who was called Assmann. I was commanded to enter the village inn. Shaking my head and hitching up my trousers, I slowly began my statement, while the sharp eyes of the party scrutinized me. I still half believed that a word would be enough to free me, a city man, and with honour too, from this peasant folk. But when I had stepped over the threshold of the inn the judge, who had hastened in front and was already awaiting me, said: 'I'm really sorry for this man.' And it was beyond all possibility of doubt that by this he did not mean my present state, but something that was to happen to me. The room looked more like a prison cell than an inn parlour. Great stone flags on the floor, dark, quite bare walls, into one of which an iron rung was fixed, in the middle something that looked half a straw mattress, half an operating table.

Could I endure any other air than prison air now? That is the great question, or rather it would be if I still had any prospect of release.

1. What is the question left in the reader's mind after the first four lines? **[2 Marks]**

2. How do the villagers behave initially towards the narrator and his sister? **[2 Marks]**

3. What seems to be the villagers' attitude towards the manor house and its proprietor? **[2 Marks]**

4. What is the villagers' response to the narrator's assertion that nothing could be proved against his sister? **[3 Marks]**

5. To what is the judge referring when he says 'I'm really sorry for this man' (line 35)? **[3 Marks]**

6. State **three** ways in which the author creates tension and suspense in the story. **[6 Marks]**

7. Explain **in your own words [2 Marks each]:**

   (i) 'merely threatened it with her hand' (line 3);
   (ii) 'interrogation' (line 11);
   (iii) 'the answer was received with indifference' (line 27);
   (iv) 'A city man' (line 33).

8. Imagine that you are the narrator. Conclude your story **in no more than twenty lines.** **[8 Marks]**

[Total Marks for Section C: 34]

NOW CHECK YOUR WORK